

debt to pay for degrees from prestigious universities. Some continue to accumulate debt pursuing master's or other advanced degree programs. He said, "the degree is only valuable for maybe the first eighteen months after you graduate . . . Employers want to know your experience and what value you bring to them. The biggest problem I see today is what I like to call the over-educated and under experienced . . . They end up still having to get the entry-level job that doesn't pay them enough to afford all that debt . . . They've really just dug themselves into a hole that put them ten years behind someone that didn't get over-educated and under experienced."

Farrington advises combining your education with your experience to maximize the value of your education and increase the return on investment of education spending. His advice leads perfectly into the next strategy employed by those who have successfully hacked college—working while going to school.

Most college students find it difficult to ignore people willing to throw money at them in the form of loans with no regard to how they'll ever repay them. I witnessed this repeatedly in my career as a physical therapist. Interns I mentored routinely had \$150,000 to \$200,000 debt by the time they finished school while preparing to enter an occupation with an average starting salary in the